

What is an ocean?

Oceans are the largest bodies of water on Earth. These huge, underwater habitats are home to millions of different types of plants and animals. Oceans are salty because when water evaporates into the air it leaves behind salt.

Deep blue sea

Bright sunshine makes clear seawater look blue. This is because water can absorb, or take in, all the colors in sunlight except blue, which is reflected instead.

Seas and lakes

The main differences between seas and lakes are their size and saltiness. Seas are bigger and saltier than lakes. Lakes almost always have fresh water, which is not salty.



Mediterranean Sea
by Sardinia, Italy

Seas are smaller than oceans, but are connected to them. There are many more seas than oceans. Almost all of our seas are salt water.